

# Frequently Asked Questions: Sexual and Reproductive Health

Every person deserves accurate information about sexual and reproductive health so they can make informed decisions about their health and their future.

Many of our cultural values and religious beliefs encourage us to care for one another, protect life and build strong families. However, some myths and misconceptions can prevent people from taking the information they need or accessing important health information.

This Frequently Asked Questions (FAQ) guide provides simple, accurate answers to some of the most common questions about family planning and sexual and reproductive health.

## 1 Is family planning only for married people?

**No.** Family planning information and services are available to help people make informed decisions about if and when to have children. Everyone deserves accurate information to make healthy choices.

## 2 Can family planning stop a woman from having children in the future?

**No.** Modern family planning methods do not cause permanent infertility. Most women are able to become pregnant after they stop using contraceptives, although the time it takes may vary depending on the method.

## 3 Does family planning make young people want to have sex?

**No.** Giving young people accurate information does not encourage them to have sex. It helps them make informed and responsible decisions, avoid unintended pregnancies and protect their health.

## 4 Can an unmarried woman or girl get family planning information?

**Yes.** Every person has the right to receive accurate information about their reproductive health. Family planning information should be for everyone because it's universal.

## 5 Should a young person be turned away from a health facility because of their age?

**No.** Young people should be treated with respect, privacy and dignity. Health workers should provide appropriate information, counselling and services in line with Kenyan laws and policies, while encouraging the support of parents or caregivers when appropriate.

## 6 Why do young people need information about sexual and reproductive health?

Young people go through many physical and emotional changes as they grow. Accurate information helps them understand their bodies, avoid unintended pregnancies, prevent HIV and other infections, and know when to seek healthcare.

## 7 Should parents talk to their children about growing up and reproductive health?

**Yes.** Parents and caregivers are the first teachers in a child's life. Honest, age-appropriate conversations help young people make healthy decisions and build trust within families.

## 8 Can our culture and faith help us build healthier families?

**Yes.** Our culture and faith teach us values like love, respect, responsibility and caring for one another. These same values can guide us in making informed choices about health, strengthening families and supporting the wellbeing of our communities.



## 9 Why is it important to leave enough time between pregnancies?

**No.** Spacing pregnancies gives a mother's body time to recover, reduces health risks for both mother and baby, and helps families stay healthy.

## 10 Should a girl leave school if she becomes pregnant?

**No.** Every girl deserves the opportunity to continue her education. Supporting pregnant and parenting learners helps them build a better future for themselves and their children.

## 11 Is reproductive health only a woman's responsibility?

**No.** Men and women both have an important role in making informed decisions, supporting one another and building healthy families.

## 12 Should I go to a health facility if I have problems after a miscarriage or abortion?

**Yes.** Anyone with heavy bleeding, severe pain, fever or other complications after a miscarriage or abortion should seek medical care immediately. Early treatment can save lives.

## 13 Why should women go for cervical or breast cancer screening if they feel healthy?

Some cancers do not show signs in the early stages. Regular screening helps find problems early, when treatment is most effective.

## 14 Is violence in the home a private family matter?

**No.** Violence is never acceptable. Anyone experiencing violence should seek help from a health facility, community support services or the appropriate authorities. Communities should support survivors with care and respect.

## 15 Where can I get correct information about sexual and reproductive health?

You can get reliable information from:

- Public health facilities.
- Community Health Promoters (CHPs).
- Trained healthcare workers.
- Government health education programmes.
- Trusted community outreach programmes.

**Know the Facts. Protect Your Health.**

